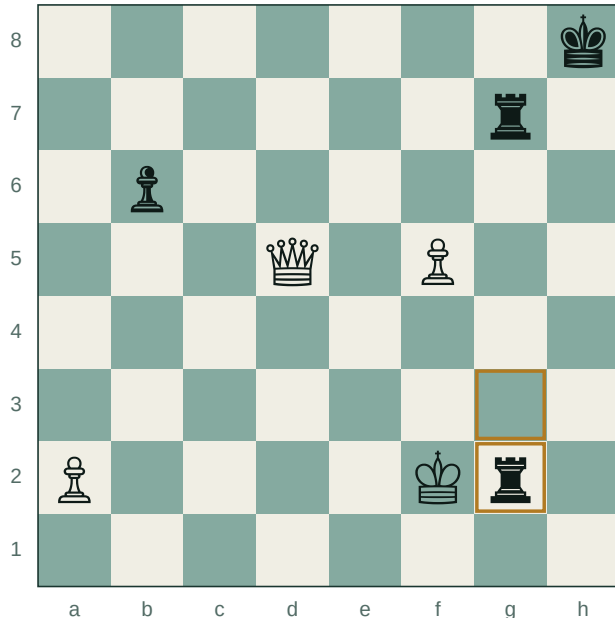


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 45

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 44...Rg2+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45. Qxg2 Rxg2+ 46. Kxg2

45.Qxg2 The queen captures the rook on g2. Recorded reply: **45...Rxg2+**.

46.Kxg2 The king captures the rook on g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on h8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.